

# Articles of Incorporation

Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order

## Articles of Incorporation

***Name*** *The name of the corporation is Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order. The corporation may use lawful trade names or ceremonial styles approved by the Board, provided that no such name falsely implies governmental, military, ecclesiastical, or historical authority not actually possessed by the corporation.*

***Duration*** *The corporation shall have perpetual duration unless dissolved according to law.*

***Nonprofit Nature*** *This corporation is a nonprofit, nonstock corporation and is not organized for the private gain of any person. No part of the net earnings, income, or assets of the corporation shall inure to the benefit of any director, officer, member, or private individual, except for reasonable compensation for services rendered and lawful reimbursements in furtherance of the corporation's nonprofit purposes.*

***Purposes*** *This corporation is organized exclusively for lawful nonprofit purposes, including charitable, educational, religious, historical, literary, scientific, and fraternal purposes as permitted under the laws of the State of [State] and the Internal Revenue Code.*

The purposes include: (1) establishing and maintaining a chivalric-inspired nonprofit order devoted to honor, service, charity, learning, and fellowship; (2) studying, preserving, and teaching the history, symbolism, and traditions associated with the medieval Knights Templar and related historical institutions; (3) conducting educational lectures, publications, classes, conferences, and heritage programs for members and the public; (4) supporting charitable, benevolent, and humanitarian work, including relief efforts, scholarships, grants, and community service; (5) supporting spiritual observance, chaplaincy, or ethical formation to the extent adopted by the corporation's bylaws; (6) organizing and supervising a parent body and, if authorized, subordinate commanderies, preceptories, chapters, priories, lodges, or houses under charter from the corporation; and (7) adopting ceremonial offices, titles, regalia, insignia, and internal systems of rank inspired by historical precedent, provided that all such offices and titles remain symbolic, educational, spiritual, charitable, fraternal, or administrative in nature.

***Limitations*** *The corporation shall not be organized or operated for any unlawful purpose. The corporation shall not function as a militia, paramilitary body, law-enforcement organization, private security force, or armed patrol. The corporation shall not claim or exercise governmental, military, police, ecclesiastical, or sovereign authority not lawfully granted. No title, insignia, or ceremonial rank of the corporation shall be construed as conferring legal authority outside the corporation's internal governance.*

***Federal Tax Status*** *The corporation shall be organized and operated in a manner consistent with qualification for tax-exempt status under one or more applicable provisions of Section 501(c) of the Internal Revenue Code, as determined by the Board.*

If the corporation seeks recognition under Section 501(c)(3), it shall be organized exclusively for religious, charitable, educational, and other exempt purposes within the meaning of Section 501(c)(3); no substantial part of its activities shall consist of propaganda or attempts to influence legislation except as permitted by law; and it shall not participate or intervene in any political campaign on behalf of or in opposition to any candidate for public office.

***Membership*** *The corporation may have one or more classes of members, or no members, as provided in the bylaws. Any internal classes of membership, including Knights, Sergeants, Chaplains, Squires, Novices, or similar offices or degrees, shall exist solely for the internal fraternal, ceremonial, spiritual, educational, or administrative governance of the corporation.*

***Governance*** *The affairs of the corporation shall be managed by or under the direction of a Board of Directors in accordance with applicable state law and the bylaws. The corporation may establish internal officers and ceremonial officers, including but not limited to a Grand Master, Seneschal, Marshal, Treasurer, Chancellor, Prior, Draper, Preceptor, Commander, or other titles inspired by historical models, provided that the bylaws define the legal and administrative authority of such offices in compliance with state law.*

The corporation may charter subordinate bodies or local units, each of which shall be subject to the constitution, bylaws, charter, regulations, and lawful authority of the parent corporation.

***Registered Office and Agent*** *The street address of the initial registered office in the State of [State] is [Registered Office Address]. The name of the initial registered agent at that address is [Registered Agent Name].*

***Principal Office*** *The principal office address of the corporation is [Principal Office Address]. The corporation may maintain such additional offices as the Board may determine.*

***Incorporator*** *The name and address of the incorporator are [Incorporator Name] and [Incorporator Address].*

***Initial Directors*** *If required or permitted by state law, the names and addresses of the initial directors are: [Name and Address], [Name and Address], and [Name and Address]. The number of directors may thereafter be fixed by the bylaws, subject to state law.*

***Liability and Indemnification*** *To the fullest extent permitted by the laws of the State of [State], a director shall not be personally liable to the corporation for monetary damages for breach of fiduciary duty as a director, except to the extent such limitation is not permitted by law. The corporation shall indemnify its directors, officers, and agents to the fullest extent permitted by law, as further provided in the bylaws or by Board resolution.*

***Asset Dedication and Dissolution*** *The property of this corporation is irrevocably dedicated to nonprofit purposes. No part of the assets, income, or profits shall ever be distributed to or inure to the benefit of any private person, except as lawful compensation or reimbursement.*

Upon dissolution, assets remaining after payment of all debts and liabilities shall be distributed exclusively for one or more exempt purposes within the meaning of the Internal Revenue Code, consistent with the corporation's recognized tax-exempt status at the time of dissolution. If recognized under Section 501(c)(3), such assets shall be distributed to one or more organizations qualifying under Section 501(c)(3), or to a federal, state, or local government for a public purpose.

***Powers and Execution The corporation shall have all powers conferred by the nonprofit corporation laws of the State of [State], except as limited by the Articles, the bylaws, and applicable federal law.***

Executed on the \_\_\_\_ day of \_\_\_\_\_, 20\_\_\_\_.

[Incorporator Name], Incorporator